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New Construction Review

VALUATION CORE

Capture new value on the right date, at the right percent complete.

THE PROBLEM

What you’re facing

Permitted construction must be found, measured, and added to the roll at the correct value and the correct point in time — partial completions included.

WHY IT MATTERS

What’s at stake

Uncaptured new construction is the most common source of both lost revenue and inequity: the neighbor who built and got missed pays less than the one who got caught. In WA, new construction has its own valuation date (July 31) layered on the January 1 lien date.

THE MENTAL MODEL

How experts think

Experts reconcile three lists that never quite agree: permits issued, structures on the ground, and structures on the roll. The gap between them is the work. They value to percent-complete as of the assessment date and resist the urge to wait for “done.”

Workflow

1. Reconcile issued permits against the current improvement record.
2. Field-verify existence and percent complete as of the assessment date.
3. Value the added improvement (RCNLD or market-supported) for the new-construction date.
4. Add to the roll with the supporting permit + field evidence attached.
5. Queue the remainder for the next cycle if still partial.

Common mistakes

- Waiting for completion and missing the assessment-date value.
- Never reconciling permits against what’s actually on the roll.
- Adding value with no field verification behind it.
- Ignoring the separate new-construction valuation date.

Tools

Permit feed Improvement record Cost service (e.g., Marshall & Swift) Field/photo evidence

DO THIS NEXT

Now What?

1. Pull the permit-vs-roll gap list and field-verify the highest-value items first.
2. Value to percent-complete as of the assessment date — don’t wait.
3. Attach the permit + ph…

Further reading: RCW 36.21.08… …eal Property